Odisha Gram Panchayat Development -- Analytical Findings Report

Department of Panchayati Raj & Drinking Water, Government of Odisha

Automated MetaInsight Analysis

Top Findings Across the Programme

Overspending against plan is not concentrated in a single block. Across 27/28 asset categories for costed activities, it is spread broadly across blocks; Banking Facilities is the only category where this pattern does not hold. The underlying activity-volume shares are Bhubaneswar 13.7%, Kalimela 8.2%, Rangeilunda 7.9%, Boipariguda 7.1%, Barpali 6.7%, Bheden 6.6%, Laxmipur 6.4%, Baranga 5.9%, Khajuripada 5.9%, Khallikote 5.5%, Tangi Choudwar 5.5%, Balisankara 5.0%, Kalyansingpur 4.3%, Lahunipara 4.0%, Attabira 3.8% and Sheragada 3.5%. These are shares of the 5,630 activities in scope, not performance measures.

No area was given more weight than another.

Overspending requires a programme-wide response

The spread of overspending means that review should not begin by searching for one block to account for the programme-wide position. It should begin with the planning, sanctioning and expenditure controls applied across blocks, while separately examining Banking Facilities. For costed activities, records with “Activity Approved” status show the lowest overspending against plan in nearly all Gram Panchayats; **Boipariguda** and **Laxmipur** have no clear pattern. The key issue is where the recorded position changes as activities move beyond approval.

Sanctions and expenditure are moving in different directions

Activity-linked expenditure increases across every time view examined and rises over quarters in most districts. Sanctioned totals, however, decrease over fiscal years in most districts. **Kandhamal** records an increasing sanction trend, while **Khordha**, **Ganjam** and **Rayagada** show no clear trend. These findings do not establish whether expenditure growth and sanction decline concern the same activities or funding cycles; that alignment needs to be checked in review.

Cash processing also has a strong timing dimension. Payment counts show recurring patterns below the fiscal-year level, while the fiscal-year view has no clear seasonal pattern. Bhubaneswar records the highest payment count in most fiscal years, except 2024-2025, when no clear leader appears. Payment volume should be treated as workload, not as a delivery rating.

Planning records need sharper classification and status scrutiny

In public works, “Uncategorised” contains the highest activity count in nearly all Gram Panchayats, with **Govindapur** following a different pattern. This limits the Department’s ability to read the asset mix cleanly. At the same time, “Activity Approved” holds the highest expected beneficiary total in nearly all Gram Panchayats, while ongoing works account for most of the recorded generated amount among costed activities. **Boipariguda** and **Laxmipur** again have no clear status pattern. The relationship between approval status, beneficiary commitments, financial generation and physical progress therefore warrants direct verification.

Questions for the next departmental review

- At what stage between GPDP approval, sanction and payment does overspending against plan emerge across blocks, and what is different in Banking Facilities?
- How do districts reconcile decreasing sanctioned totals with increasing activity-linked expenditure, especially the contrary or unclear district trends?
- What action will Gram Panchayats take to resolve “Uncategorised” public works and verify the status, beneficiary and financial records of approved and ongoing activities?

Activity Lifecycle - Every Planned Work and Its Money

Planned Money Is Not Converting into Spending

Across costed activities, spending against the planned cost shows a difference of Rs -51.96 crore. This is not confined to a few blocks or asset categories: the shortfall is spread across all 16 blocks for almost every asset grouping, so review action cannot be limited to a small set of locations.

The lowest utilisation of planned cost is in Kalimela block at 23.0% (Rs 1.76 crore spent of Rs 7.65 crore planned cost), against 8.2% of costed activities, and Rangeilunda block at 23.1% (Rs 2.73 crore spent of Rs 11.84 crore planned cost), against 7.9% of costed activities. Even the stronger blocks listed remain around half utilised: Baranga block is at 52.9% (Rs 1.24 crore spent of Rs 2.34 crore planned cost), against 5.9% of costed activities.

The status records locate much of this unspent plan. Activities recorded only as Activity Approved are 0.3% spent (Rs 14.00 lakh spent of Rs 41.75 crore planned cost) and account for 53.9% of costed activities. Ongoing works are 85.4% spent (Rs 24.76 crore spent of Rs 28.99 crore planned cost) and account for 37.5%. Abandoned works are only 3.6% spent (Rs 21.03 lakh spent of Rs 5.85 crore planned cost) and account for 7.5%. The completed category is 100.8% spent (Rs 24.17 lakh spent of Rs 23.98 lakh planned cost), but it contains only 17 activities and cannot support a wider conclusion about repeated overspending by particular Gram Panchayats.

Tied Grant Requires Sanction-Level Verification

97.6% of the XV Finance Commission tied grant is recorded against the two earmarked purposes, while Rs 42.61 lakh sits outside them. The tied part is earmarked—one half for sanitation and maintenance of open-defecation-free status, the other for drinking water supply, rainwater harvesting and water recycling. The amount outside these purposes is recorded under Roads at Rs 31.01 lakh, Education at Rs 8.05 lakh and Water Conservation at Rs 3.55 lakh. The review should identify which sanction records carry these amounts and under which head each was approved; the data alone does not establish whether the department treats each entry as outside the permitted purposes.

Infrastructure Dominates Planned Untied Funding

Theme 6 - Self-sufficient Infrastructure in Village carries Rs 30.07 crore of planned untied funding, or 50.4%, while accounting for 32.6% of costed activities. This is the leading theme in 18 of the 20 Gram Panchayats. The actionable exceptions are **Boipariguda**, where Unmapped theme leads, and **Kalimela**, where Theme 4 - Water Sufficient Village leads. Officials should establish whether these are deliberate local planning choices and, in Boipariguda, correct the missing theme mapping.

Sanctions, Spending and Evidence Records Need Reconciliation

Among activities with a sanction record, the district-level difference between spending and sanctioned amount is Rs -5.02 crore and is spread across districts rather than concentrated in one place. Ganjam is at 73.3% of sanctioned amount spent (Rs 4.61 crore spent of Rs 6.30 crore sanctioned amount), against 21.4% of all activities. Cuttack is at 92.0% (Rs 2.14 crore spent of Rs 2.33 crore sanctioned amount), against 8.7% of activities. These percentages apply only to activities with sanction records, not to the full programme.

Chikilli records Rs 0 sanctioned amount across every fiscal year despite accounting for 5.0% of activities. Both readings remain open: either no sanction amount was recorded for these activities, or the sanction records are missing from the system.

Record classification also limits scrutiny. Among Public Works, 5,181 activities, or 55.0%, are Uncategorised. For New/Fresh works, 6,893 photo uploads, or 100.0%, sit in one output category with no description on file, although that category accounts for 32.8% of such activities. The department must supply the output-category decode before this concentration can be interpreted.

At the review, the officer should ask: Which blocks will reconcile the large planned-cost balances, particularly for activities still recorded only as Activity Approved? Why does **Chikilli** have Rs 0 sanctioned amount on file—is nothing being sanctioned, or is nothing being entered? Which sanctioning offices approved the Rs 42.61 lakh of tied grant recorded under Roads, Education and Water Conservation, and under what heads?

> **Reading note:** this view has one row for each of the **12,704 activities** the 20 Gram Panchayats planned, and three of its properties are features of the data rather than results. First, **costless activities** -- training, campaigns and services planned without a cost -- only began being reported in 2023-24, and they are 7,074 of the 12,704 rows, so activity counts rise about eightfold at that

boundary for a reporting reason. Second, Sanction records exist for **2,101 of the 12,704 activities** (about one in six), so every sanctioned-basis figure -- sanctioned amounts, approval counts, and overspend against sanction -- describes that subset only. An activity with no sanction record is **not** shown to be unapproved; it is shown to have no record on file. Third, only **17 activities are marked WORK COMPLETED** in the whole sample, so completion rates here measure recording practice, not delivery. Activity-count comparisons across FY 2023-24 reflect a change in reporting completeness (costless activities begin being recorded), not a change in activity. On the tied grant specifically: the XV Finance Commission's tied grant is earmarked for sanitation and for drinking water, and **97.6%** of the **Rs 17.66 crore** of tied grant in this data sits on those two focus areas. **Rs 42.61 lakh** sits outside them -- Roads (Rs 31.01 lakh), Education (Rs 8.05 lakh), Water Conservation (Rs 3.55 lakh). Whether those purposes fall inside the earmark is for the department to say; this analysis reports the split and does not establish a breach.

Monthly Money Flows by Gram Panchayat

Cashbook movement remains concentrated around year-end

Payments, receipts and their voucher counts follow a repeating 12-month cycle. March—the fiscal year-end—is the recurring concentration point rather than cashbook movement being spread evenly through the year. This matters operationally because a large year-end payment load leaves less time within the financial year to resolve rejected vouchers, incomplete entries or delayed transactions.

The pattern applies to both payment and receipt activity, but not cleanly to sanctions. Sanction counts increase when viewed by quarter and fiscal year, while the monthly sanction series follows a different pattern. The review should therefore examine whether sanction timing and cashbook payment timing are aligned, rather than treating the March payment concentration as part of a uniform administrative cycle.

A small number of blocks account for much of the voucher activity

Bhubaneswar recorded 2,135 vouchers, or 25.0% of the total 8,529 vouchers. It had the highest payment-voucher count in five of the six fiscal years; 2024-2025 was the exception, when no block stood out clearly. **Rangeilunda** recorded 945 vouchers, or 11.1%, and **Bheden** recorded 885 vouchers, or 10.4%.

These are absolute volumes, not measures of performance. Nevertheless, the persistence of Bhubaneswar's position warrants a transaction-level review: is the volume spread across the year and across the Gram Panchayats in the block, or concentrated in a small number of months or Gram Panchayats? The absence of a clear leading block in 2024-2025 should also be checked against the underlying monthly entries to establish whether activity became more evenly distributed or whether recording patterns changed.

District and block comparisons need both totals and monthly intensity

In 2025-2026, **Ganjam** stood out on total payment amount, receipt amount, receipt vouchers, sanctions and sanctioned amount. It also accounted for 26.1% of the 1,985 vouchers in scope, so part of its prominence is its share of transaction volume. On the more comparable measure—a typical month for one Gram Panchayat—Ganjam recorded payment outflow of Rs 7.78 lakh. **Cuttack** was close at Rs 7.58 lakh, while **Khordha** recorded Rs 5.49 lakh. Ganjam therefore leads the total comparison, but does not stand alone once the number of Gram Panchayats and months is taken into account.

Within Bargarh district, **Bheden** accounted for 57.2% of the 1,546 vouchers and had a typical monthly payment outflow of Rs 8.74 lakh per Gram Panchayat. This was well above **Barpali** at Rs 2.28 lakh and **Attabira** at Rs 2.22 lakh. Barpali, however, had the highest sanction count and sanctioned amount among the three blocks. The department should test whether the different rankings of sanctions and cashbook movement persist at Gram Panchayat level and identify the months in which they separate.

Sudden shifts require record-level explanation

Ganjam's payment amounts, receipt amounts and payment and receipt voucher counts all show a sharp shift in 2020-08. Its sanction count and sanctioned amount shifted in 2020-10. The data identifies the timing but not the reason. The sequence should be checked against the underlying sanction dates, receipt entries and payment vouchers to distinguish an actual change in money movement from a change in when records were entered.

Questions for the departmental review

Why do payments and receipts continue to concentrate in March, and which blocks have the largest month-end voucher queues? What changed in Ganjam between 2020-08 and 2020-10 across cashbook entries and sanctions? In Bargarh district, why does Bheden show much higher monthly payment intensity while Barpali records the highest sanction volume, and which Gram Panchayats and months account for that separation?

> **Reading note:** this view's time axis is the **cashbook's own 72 months** (April 2020 to March 2026), and a Gram Panchayat month with no transactions is present as a row of zeros rather than absent -- 259 of the 1,440 cells are such months. Two consequences follow. Sanctions are counted by **sanction month**, so the **2,040** sanctions dated inside the window are here and **61** dated outside it are not; the yearly report card counts the full 2,101 by fiscal year, and both totals are correct for their own axis. And **March concentrates payments every year** -- 2,040 of the 8,529 payment vouchers fall in a March -- which is the fiscal-year end, a known property of government cash flow. On activity-linked expenditure specifically: the cashbook's total outflow did **not** grow across these six years (**Rs 15.60 crore** in 2020-21 against **Rs 11.12 crore** in 2025-26), while the share of it carrying a link to a planned activity rose from **2.7%** to **53.2%**, and the number of recorded activity-voucher links rose from **30** to **2,122**. A rise in activity-linked expenditure is therefore a rise in recording completeness unless the cashbook total rises with it. A dated event overlaps this section: the period this finding is restricted to falls inside and the shift this finding reports falls in the months

just after the COVID-19 first-wave lockdown (2020-03 to 2020-06). The national COVID-19 lockdown was imposed on 25 March 2020 and unwound in phases through June 2020. Public works and Gram Panchayat office operations across Odisha were restricted for most of that window. The dates coincide; this analysis does not establish that one produced the other.

Gram Panchayat Report Card by Year

Recorded Sanctioned Value Is Falling in Most Districts

Recorded sanctioned value shows a decreasing six-year trend in five of the nine districts represented: **Bargarh**, **Koraput**, **Cuttack**, **Sundargarh** and **Malkangiri**. Across the report card, the sanctioned total was Rs 6.13 crore in 2020-2021, accounting for 21.2% of the six-year total. It was Rs 5.51 crore in 2021-2022 (19.1%), before reaching Rs 3.57 crore in 2025-2026 (12.4%). The intervening totals were Rs 4.45 crore in 2022-2023, Rs 4.56 crore in 2023-2024 and Rs 4.63 crore in 2024-2025.

The important exception is **Kandhamal**, where recorded sanctioned value is increasing. **Khordha**, **Ganjam** and **Rayagada** show no clear direction. These different trajectories require separate district responses rather than a common explanation.

This matters because a sustained fall in recorded sanctioned value can weaken the link between the annual plan and authorised execution. However, sanction records are available for only about one activity in six. The report card therefore cannot establish whether the falling value represents fewer sanctions or incomplete entry of sanctions. District and block officials should be required to reconcile the report card with their sanction registers, particularly in the five districts showing a decreasing trend.

Bargarh: Similar Activity Shares, Different Conversion of Plans into Spending

Within **Bargarh**, the 3,062 activities are distributed quite evenly across the four Gram Panchayats: **Bheden** accounts for 27.4%, **Hirlipali** 25.4%, **Bandhpali** 23.8% and **Bhatigaon** 23.4%. Counts of activities, administrative and technical sanction records, ongoing works, activities with geotagged evidence and evidence uploads are also broadly spread across the four Gram Panchayats. The same applies to expenditure and the signed differences between spending and planned or sanctioned amounts. This does not mean performance is healthy; it means no single Gram Panchayat accounts for these patterns, so review must cover all four.

Conversion of planned cost into expenditure is much less uniform. **Bheden**, with 27.4% of the activities, spent 22.4% of its planned cost (Rs 1.62 crore spent of Rs 7.22 crore planned cost). **Bandhpali**, with 23.8% of the activities, spent 41.9% (Rs 1.40 crore spent of Rs 3.34 crore planned cost). **Hirlipali**, with 25.4% of the activities, spent 48.3% (Rs 1.19 crore spent of Rs 2.46 crore planned cost), while **Bhatigaon**, with 23.4% of the activities, spent 57.7% (Rs 1.24 crore spent of Rs 2.14 crore planned cost).

Plan counts, recorded sanctioned value and completed activities have no clear distribution across these Gram Panchayats. Costed activities, planned cost, cashbook payments and receipts, and abandoned activities also do not follow the otherwise even spread. Officials should therefore examine each Gram Panchayat's yearly sequence from planning through sanction, cashbook expenditure and evidence rather than treating Bargarh's similar activity shares as similar delivery.

Questions for the Departmental Review

First, in **Bargarh**, **Koraput**, **Cuttack**, **Sundargarh** and **Malkangiri**, does the decreasing recorded sanctioned value match the sanction registers, or are sanctions not being entered against GPDP activities?

Second, why did **Bheden** spend only 22.4% of its planned cost while **Bhatigaon** spent 57.7%, and which specific GP-years and activities account for each position?

Third, for each of the four Bargarh Gram Panchayats, which GP-years show cashbook expenditure without corresponding geotagged evidence, and what action is pending to complete or correct the records?

> **Reading note:** this view is a full grid -- all 20 Gram Panchayats against all 6 fiscal years, 120 rows -- so a **zero is a recorded zero**, not a missing row. It can mean either that nothing happened or that nothing was recorded, and this view cannot tell those apart. **Completion recording effectively ceased after 2022-23**: the 17 activities ever marked WORK COMPLETED fall 3 / 6 / 6 across 2020-21 to 2022-23, then 0, 2 and 0 across the three years since. No comparison of Gram Panchayats on completions can be supported by this column, and trend patterns on it are reported in the data-quality annex rather than as findings. Sanction records exist for **2,101 of the 12,704 activities** (about one in six), so every sanctioned-basis figure -- sanctioned amounts, approval counts, and overspend against sanction -- describes that subset only. An activity with no sanction record is **not** shown to be unapproved; it is shown to have no record on file. `n_tech_approvals` totals **2,095**, not the 2,134 technical-approval records in the source: 39 sit on activities that have no administrative approval, and the approval view hangs the technical approval off the administrative one. The Ask chatbot reports the same 2,095, so the two systems agree.

Data-Quality Annex

This section is generated from the mining run's own record, not written up from the findings. It lists what the analysis declined to report as a finding, and why -- so that a column nobody is filling in is visible as a recording problem rather than absent from the report or, worse, present in it as a performance result.

Gram Panchayat Report Card by Year

- **`n_abandoned` over fiscal_year** carries too little non-zero data to support a time pattern: of the 46 series the engine would read, 28 fall below the guard (at least 4 non-zero points and at least 33% of the series non-zero), with between 0 and 6 non-zero points each. The column is non-zero on 54 of the view's rows. A time pattern over a series that is mostly zeros describes the recording, so none is reported as a finding.
- **`n_completed` over fiscal_year** carries too little non-zero data to support a time pattern: of the 46 series the engine would read, 42 fall below the guard (at least 4 non-zero points and at least 33% of the series non-zero), with between 0 and 4 non-zero points each. The column is non-zero on 7 of the view's rows. A time pattern over a series that is mostly zeros describes the recording, so none is reported as a finding.
- **`n_costless` over fiscal_year** carries too little non-zero data to support a time pattern: of the 46 series the engine would read, 46 fall below the guard (at least 4 non-zero points and at least 33% of the series non-zero), with between 3 and 3 non-zero points each. The column is non-zero on 60 of the view's rows. A time pattern over a series that is mostly zeros describes the recording, so none is reported as a finding.